

0.0.1 Vasettha

1. Thus was heard by me. At one time the Auspicious One was dwelling at Icchanangala in the Icchanangala Forest Grove. At that time many well-known wealthy brahmins were dwelling at Icchānangala, such as: the brahmin Canki, the brahmin Tarukkha, the brahmin Pokkharasati, the brahmin Janussoṇi, the brahmin Todeyya, and many other well-known and wealthy brahmins.

2. Then brahmin youths Vasettha and Bharadvaja while walking and wandering about, walking along back and forth, this talk arose between them: “How indeed is one a brahmin?” The brah-

vāseṭṭhasuttam

evaṃ mesutaṃ: ekaṃ samayaṃ bhagavā icchānaṅgale viharati icchānaṅgalavanasaṇḍe. tena kho pana samayena sambahulā abhiññātā abhiññātā brāhmaṇamahāsālā icchānaṅgale paṭivasanti. seyyathidaṃ: caṅkī brāhmaṇo, tārukko brāhmaṇo, pokkharasāti brāhmaṇo, jānussoṇi brāhmaṇo, todeyyo brāhmaṇo, añño ca abhiññātā abhiññātā brāhmaṇamahāsālā.

atha kho vāseṭṭha-bhāradvājānaṃ māṇavaṇaṃ jaṅghāvihāraṃ anucaṅkamaṇānaṃ anuvicara-

min youth Bharadvaja said thus: “So far as, dear Sir, one is well borne, of pure descent from both the maternal and paternal sides as far back as seven generations, unblemished and irreproachable with regard to ancestry, it is to this extent, dear Sir, that one is a brahmin.” The brahmin youth Vasettha said thus: “So far as, dear Sir, one is virtuous and excels in religious duties, it is to this extent, dear Sir, that one is a brahmin.”. Neither was the brahmin youth Bharadvaja able to convince the brahmin youth Vasettha, nor was the brahmin youth Vasettha able to convince the brahmin youth Bharadvaja.

mānānaṃ¹ ayamantarā kathā udapādi:
' kathambho brāhmaṇo hoti'ti. bhāradvājo māṇavo evamāha: yato kho bho ubhato sujāto hoti mātito ca pitito ca, saṃsuddhagahaṇiko yāva sattamā pitāmahayugā akkhitto anupakkuṭṭho jātivādena. ettāvata kho bho, brāhmaṇo hoti'ti. vāseṭṭho māṇavo evamāha: 'yato kho bho, sīlavā ca hoti vatasampanno² ca. ettāvata kho bho, brāhmaṇo hoti'ti. neva kho asakkhī bhāradvājo māṇavo vāseṭṭhaṃ māṇavaṃ saññāpetuṃ. na pana asakkhī vāseṭṭho māṇavo bhāra-

¹anucaṇkamantānaṃ anuvicarantānaṃ - machasaṃ, syā. ■

²vattasampanno - machasaṃ, simu, syā. ■

3. So then, brahmin youth Vasettha address the brahmin youth, Bharadvaja Master Bharadvaja, there is this samana Gotama, son of the Sakyans who has gone forth from the Sakyan clan, dwelling at Icchānaṅgala in the Icchānaṅgala Forest Grove. Now a good reputation has been spread about that Auspicious Gotama thus: “Truly is he the Auspicious One, the Arahant, rightly self-awakened, excelling in knowledge and conduct, well-farer, knower of worlds, incomparable charioteer of tamed persons, teacher of devas and humans, awakened, auspicious.” We must visit with the samana Gotama, O Master Bharadvaja. Upon arrival, we must ask the samana Gotama about this matter. In which ever way the samana

dvājaṃ māṇavaṃ
saññāpetuṃ.

atha kho vāsetṭho
māṇavo bhāradvā-
jaṃ māṇavaṃ āman-
tesi: 'ayaṃ kho bho
bhāradvāja, samaṇo
gotamo sakyaputto
sakyakulā pabbajito
icchānaṅgale viha-
rati icchānaṅgalava-
nasaṇḍe. taṃ kho
pana bhagavantam
gotamaṃ evaṃ kal-
yāṇo kittisaddo ab-
bhuggato: itipi so
bhagavā araham
sammāsambuddho
vijjācaraṇasampanno
sugato lokavidū anut-
taro purisadammasā-
rathī satthā devama-
nussānaṃ buddho
bhagavā'ti. āyāma
bho bhāradvāja, yena
samaṇo gotamo te-
nupasaṅkamissāma.
upasaṅkamitvā sa-
maṇam gotamaṃ

Gotama will answer, in just that way we must bear it in mind.”

4. So then, the brahmin youths Vasettha and Bharadvāja visited with the Auspicious One. Having approached, they exchanged friendly greetings with the Auspicious One. Having exchanged friendly greetings and cordial talk, they sat down to one side. Having sat down to one side, the brahmin youth Vasettha addressed the Auspicious One in verse:

We are accepted and acknowledged,
as triple knowledge masters;

etamatthaṃ pucchis-
sāma. yathā no sa-
maṇo gotamo byā-
karissati. tathā naṃ
dhāressāmā'ti. eva-
bhoti kho bhāradvājo
māṇavo vāseṭṭhassa
māṇavassa paccas-
sosi.

atha kho vāseṭṭha,
bhāradvājā māṇavā
yena bhagavā tenu-
pasāṅkamiṃsu. upa-
saṅkamitvā bhaga-
vatā saddhiṃ sam-
modiṃsu, sammo-
danīyaṃ kathaṃ
sārāṇiyaṃ vītisāre-
tvā ekamantaṃ nisī-
diṃsu. ekamantaṃ
nisinno kho vāseṭṭho
māṇavo bhagavan-
taṃ gāthāhī ajjha-
bhāsi:

anuññātapatiññātā,
tevijjā mayamassu
bho;
ahaṃ pokkharasā-

I am Pokkharasāti's student,
and this is Tārukkha's student.

Of the three knowledges
which are declared,
there is perfection [by us];
from its etymology and grammar,
we are equal to our teachers in recitation.

For us in regard to ancestry,
there is a dispute, O Gotama;
one is a brahmin from birth,
Bharadvaja speaks thus;
but I say by kamma,
know thus, O One Endowed with Eyes.

We are both unable,
to convince one another;
to question the Auspicious One we have come,

tissa,
tārukkhasāyaṃ māṇavo.

tevijjānaṃ yadakkhātaṃ,
tattha kevalino'smase;
padakasmā veyyākaraṇā³,
jappe ācariyasādisā.

tesaṃ no jātivādasamim,
vivādo atthi gotama;
jātiyā brāhmaṇo hoti,
bhāradvajo iti bhāsati;
ahañca kammanā brūmi,
evaṃ jānāhi cakkhuma.

te na sakkoma ñāpetum,
aññaṃaññaṃ mayaṃ ubho;

³no byākaraṇā - simu

the Awakened One renowned
thus.

As the newly formed
waxing moon,
people worship with
hands in anjali;
they paying homage to
the moon,
so in the world is Go-
tama;
the eye arisen in the
world,
we ask you Gotama.

Is one a brahmin by
birth,
or by kamma;
tell us, we who do not
know,
how we may know a
brahmin.

For you, I will distin-
guish,
one and the other be-
cause of their species;

bhagavantam puṭṭu-
māgammā⁴,
sambuddham iti vissu-
taṃ.

candam yathā khayā-
titaṃ,
pecca pañjalikā janā;
candamānā namas-
santi,
evaṃ lokasmiṃ gota-
maṃ;
cakkhum loke samup-
pannam,
mayam pucchāma go-
tamaṃ.

jātiyā brāhmaṇo hoti,
udāhu bhavati kam-
maṇā;
ajānataṃ no pabrūhi,
yathā jānemu brāh-
maṇanti.

tesaṃ vohaṃ vyācik-

⁴puṭṭhumāgamā - machasaṃ;
puṭṭhum āgammā - syā

the analysis of birth of
living beings,
in sequence as it truly is.

Know that the grass and
trees,
even though [their birth]
is not acknowledged;
their characteristics are
made from birth,
one and the other be-
cause of their species.

Next the moths and grasshop-
pers,
up to the biting insects
and ants;
their characteristics are
made from birth,
one and the other be-
cause of their species.

Know the four footed too,
among the small and the
large;

khissam⁵ (vāsetṭhāti
bhagavā),
anupubbam yathāta-
tham;
jātivibhaṅgam paṇā-
nam,
aññamaññā hi jātiyo.

tiṇarukkhepi jānātha,
na cāpi paṭijānare;
liṅgam jātimayam te-
sam,
aññamaññā hi jātiyo.

tato kīṭe paṭaṅge ca,
yāva kunthakipillike;
liṅgam jātimayam te-
sam,
aññamaññā hi jātiyo.

catuppadepepi jānātha,
khuddake ca mahal-

⁵vo aham byakkhissam - macha-
sam ■

their characteristics are
made from birth,
one and the other be-
cause of their species.

Know those that crawl
with their stomachs
too,
serpents, long backed
crawlers;
their characteristics are
made from birth,
one and the other be-
cause of their species.

Next know from the
fishes in water too,
with water as their pas-
ture;
their characteristics are
made from birth,
one and the other be-
cause of their species.

Next know from the birds
too,
with wings as vehicles,
going by the sky;
their characteristics are
made from birth,

lake;
liṅgaṃ jātimayaṃ te-
saṃ,
aññamaññā hi jātiyo.

pādūdarepi jānātha,
urage dīghapiṭṭhike⁶;
liṅgaṃ jātimayaṃ te-
saṃ,
aññamaññā hi jātiyo.

tato macchepi jānā-
tha,
udake vārigocare;
liṅgaṃ jātimayaṃ te-
saṃ,
aññamaññā hi jātiyo.

tato pakkhīpi jānātha,
pattayāne vihaṅgame;

liṅgaṃ jātimayaṃ te-
saṃ,

⁶dighapiṭṭhake - sīma. ■

one and the other be-
cause of their species.

As among these species,
there are various char-
acteristics made from
birth;
these various character-
istics made from birth,

do not exist among hu-
mans.

Neither by head hairs nor
by head,
neither by ear nor by
eyes;
neither by face nor by
nose,
neither by mouth nor by
eyebrows.

Neither by neck nor by
shoulder,
neither by stomach nor
by back;
neither by waist nor by
breast,
neither by genitals nor by
mating.

aññamaññā hī jātiyo.

yathā etāsu jātīsu,
līṅgaṃ jātimayaṃ pu-
thu;
evaṃ natthi manus-
sesu,
līṅgaṃ jātamayaṃ pu-
thu.

na kesehi na sīsehi,
na kaṇṇehi na akkhīhi;

na mukhena na nā-
sāya,
na oṭṭhehi bhamuhi
vā.

na gīvāya na aṃsehi,
na udarena na piṭṭiyā;
na soṇiyā na urasā,
na sambādhena me-
thune.

Neither by hands nor by
feet,
neither by fingers nor by
nails;
neither by calf nor by
thigh,
neither by color nor by
voice;
certainly there are no
characteristics made
from birth,
as in the case of other
species.

But among the bodies of
individuals,
this [difference] among
humans is not to be
found;
but characteristics among
humans,
are for the sake of designation, it is said.

Indeed, whoever among
humans,
lives in dependence on
cow-keeping;
know him thus, O Vaset-
tha,

na hatthehi na pā-
dehi,
nāṅgulīhi nakhehi vā;
na jaṅghāhi na ūruhi,
na vaṇṇena sareṇa
vā;
liṅgaṃ jātimaṃ
neva,
yathā aññāsu jātisu.

paccattaṃ ca sarī-
resu,
manussesvetam na
vijjati;
vokāraṇca manus-
sesu,
samaññāya pavuccati.

yo hi koci manussesu,
gorakkhaṃ upajīvati;
evaṃ vāsetṭha jānāhi,
kassako so na brāh-
maṇo.

he is a farmer, not a brahmin.

Indeed, whoever among humans,
lives in dependence on the various kind of crafts;
know him thus, O Vasettha,
he is a craftsman, not a brahmin.

Indeed, whoever among humans,
lives in dependence on trade;
know him thus, O Vasettha,
he is a merchant, not a brahmin.

Indeed, whoever among humans,
lives in dependence on serving others;
know him thus, O Vasettha,
he is a servant, not a brahmin.

yo hi koci manussesu,
puthusippena jīvati;
evaṃ vāsetṭha jānāhi,
sippiko so na brāhmaṇo.

yo hi koci manussesu,
vohāraṃ upajīvati;
evaṃ vāsetṭha jānāhi,
vāṇijo so na brāhmaṇo.

yo hi koci manussesu,
parapessena jīvati;
evaṃ vāsetṭha jānāhi
pessiko so na brāhmaṇo.

Indeed, whoever among
humans,
lives in dependence on
what is not given;
know him thus, O Vaset-
tha,
he is a thief, not a brah-
min.

Indeed, whoever among
humans,
lives in dependence on
shooting arrows;
know him thus, O Vaset-
tha,
he is a soldier, not a
brahmin.

Indeed, whoever among
humans,
lives in dependence on
the office of chief priest;
know him thus, O Vaset-
tha,
he is a sacrificing priest,
not a brahmin.

Indeed, whoever among
humans,

yo hi koci munussesu,
adinnaṃ upajīvati;
evaṃ vāseṭṭha jānāhi,
coro eso na brāhmaṇo.

yo hi koci manussesu,
issatthaṃ upajīvati;
evaṃ vāseṭṭha jānāhi,
yodhājivo na brāh-
maṇo.

yo hi koci manussesu,
porohiccena jīvati;
evaṃ vāseṭṭha jānāhi,
yājako so na brāh-
maṇo.

yo hi koci manussesu,
gāmaṃ raṭṭhañca

enjoys [the revenue]
 from the nation and
 its villages;
 know him thus, O Vaset-
 tha,
 he is a king, not a brah-
 min.

But I do not call him a
 brahmin,
 born of a womb, begot-
 ten from a mother;
 he is called a sir-sayer,
 if he owns something;
 owning nothing, a dis-
 owner,
 it is him I call a brahmin.

Who, having cut all fet-
 ters,
 is truly not perturbed;
 who is detached with all
 bonds surmounted,
 it is him I call a brahmin.

Who having cut delight
 and the thong,
 the tether together with

bhuñjati;
 evaṃ vāseṭṭha jānāhi,
 rājā eso na brāhmaṇo.

na cāhaṃ brāhma-
 ṇaṃ brūmi,
 yonijaṃ mattisambha-
 vaṃ;
 bhovādi nāma so hoti,
 sace hoti sakiñcano;
 akiñcanaṃ anādā-
 naṃ,
 tamahaṃ brūmi brāh-
 maṇaṃ.

sabbasaññojanaṃ
 chetvā,
 yo ve na paritassati;
 saṅgātigaṃ visaññut-
 taṃ,
 tamahaṃ brūmi brāh-
 maṇaṃ.

chetvā nandiṃ varat-
 tañca,
 sandānaṃ sahanukka-

the reins;
the awakened one who
has raised the cross
bar,
it is him I call a brahmin.

Who is not offended but
forbears,
abusive speech, beating
and binding;
the powerful one with
the strength of pa-
tience,
it is him I call a brahmin.

The one endowed with
conduct, not inclined
to anger,
endowed with virtue, not
arrogant;
tamed, bearing his final
body,
it is him I call a brahmin.

Like water on lotus leaf,
like mustard seed on a
needle tip;
who is not smeared in
sensual pleasures,
it is him I call a brahmin.

mam;
ukkhittapaḷighaṃ
buddhaṃ,
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāh-
maṇaṃ.

akkosaṃ vadhaban-
dhañca,
aduṭṭho yo titikkhati;
khantibalaṃ balāṇi-
kaṃ,
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāh-
maṇaṃ.

akkodhanaṃ vatavan-
taṃ,
sīlavantaṃ anussa-
daṃ;
dantaṃ antimasārī-
raṃ,
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāh-
maṇaṃ.

vāri pokkharapatteva,
āraggeriva sāsapo;
yo na lippati⁷ kāmesu,

⁷lippi - simu, machasaṃ,
syā■

Who wisely understands
suffering,
has obliterated it right
here by himself;
who has put down the
burden, detached,
it is him I call a brahmin.

The wise one with deep
wisdom,
the expert of the path
and the non-path;
one attained to the supreme
goal,
it is him I call a brahmin.

Who mixes neither with
householders,
nor homeless ones alike;
roaming without abode,
with fewness of wishes,
it is him I call a brahmin.

Having layed aside the
rod among living be-

tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāh-
maṇaṃ.

yo dukkhassa pajā-
nāti,
idheva khayamattano;
pannabhāraṃ viṣaṃ-
yuttaṃ,
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāh-
maṇaṃ.

gambhīrapaññaṃ me-
dhāviṃ,
maggāmaggaṃ kovi-
daṃ;
uttamatthamanuppat-
taṃ,
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāh-
maṇaṃ.

asaṃsaṭṭhaṃ gahaṭ-
ṭhehi,
anāgārehi cubhayaṃ;
anokasāriṃ appic-
chaṃ,
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāh-
maṇaṃ.

nidhāya daṇḍanaṃ
bhūtesu,

ings,
both the frail and the
firm;
who neither kills nor
cause to kill,
it is him I call a brahmin.

unobstructed among
those obstructed,
extinguished in the tak-
ing up of sticks;
a disowner among own-
ers,
it is him I call a brahmin.

For whom lust and hate,
conceit and denigration
are laid down;
like mustard seed on a
needle tip,
it is him I call a brahmin.

He who utters truthful
words,
not harsh, conveying the
meaning;
who does not abuse any-
one,
it is him I call a brahmin.

tasesu thāvaresu ca;
yo na hanti na ghā-
teti,
tamahaṃ brūmi brāh-
maṇaṃ.

aviruddhaṃ virud-
dhesu,
attadaṇḍesu nibbu-
taṃ;
sādānesu anādānaṃ,
tamahaṃ brūmi brāh-
maṇaṃ.

yassa rāgo ca doso ca,
māno makkho ca ohito;

sāsaporiva āraggā,
tamahaṃ brūmi brāh-
maṇaṃ.

akakkasaṃ viññapa-
niṃ⁸,
giraṃ saccaṃ udī-
raye;

⁸viññāpaniṃ - sīmu, machasaṃ,
syā■

He who does not take
 what is not given in the
 world,
 whether long or short;
 small or big, beautiful or
 ugly;
 it is him I call a brahmin.

For whom hope is not to
 be found,
 in this world and in the
 other;
 hopeless and detached,
 it is him I call a brahmin.

For whom reliance is not
 to be found,
 having known, without
 perplexity;
 attained to firm footing
 in the deathless,
 it is him I call a brahmin.

yāya nābhisaje⁹ kiñci,
 tamahaṃ brūmi brāh-
 maṇaṃ.

yo ca dīghaṃ ca ras-
 saṃ vā,
 aṇuṃ thūlaṃ subhā-
 subhaṃ;
 loke adinnaṃ nādi-
 yati¹⁰,
 tamahaṃ brūmi brāh-
 maṇaṃ.

āsā yassa na vijjanti,
 asmiṃ loke paramhi
 ca;
 nirāsayaṃ¹¹ viṣaṃyut-
 taṃ,
 tamahaṃ brūmi brāh-
 maṇaṃ.

yassālayā navijjanti,
 aññāya akathaṅkathī
¹²;
 amatogadhaṃ anup-
 pattaṃ,
 tamahaṃ brūmi brāh-

⁹nābhisajje - machasaṃ, syā

¹⁰nādeti - machasaṃ, syā

¹¹nirāsāsaṃ - machasaṃ, syā

¹²akataṅkathī - sīmu.

Who here both merit and
demerit,
attachment to both he
has overcome;
sorrowless, stainless,
pure,
it is him I call a brahmin.

Like the moon without
stain, pure,
clear and lucid;
with delight for being
wholly obliterated,
it is him I call a brahmin.

He who has transcended
this wandering on in
delusion,
an obstruction so hard to
penetrate;
the meditator who has
crossed and gone be-
yond,
unperturbed without per-
plexity;

maṇaṃ.

yodha puññañca pā-
pañca,
ubhosaṅgaṃ upac-
cagā;
asokaṃ virajaṃ sud-
dhaṃ,
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāh-
maṇaṃ.

candaṃva vimalaṃ
suddhaṃ,
vippasannamanāvi-
laṃ;
nandībhavaparikkhī-
ṇaṃ,
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāh-
maṇaṃ.

yo imaṃ paḷipathaṃ
duggaṃ,
saṃsāraṃ mohamac-
cagā;
tiṇṇo pāragato jhāyī,
anejo akathaṅkathī;
anupādāya nibbuto,
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāh-
maṇaṃ.

without undertakings,
fully quenched,
it is him I call a brahmin.

He who having abandoned sensual pleasures here,
wanders about homeless;
with delight for sensual pleasures wholly obliterated,
it is him I call a brahmin.

He who having abandoned thirsting here,
wanders about homeless;
thirsting for being wholly obliterated,
it is him I call a brahmin.

Having abandoned the human bondage,
he has overcome the celestial bondage;
detached from all bondages,
it is him I call a brahmin.

yodha kāme paha-
tvāna,
anāgāro paribbaje;
kāmaḥavaparikkhī-
ṇaṃ,
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāh-
maṇaṃ.

yodha taṇhaṃ paha-
tvāna,
anāgāro paribbaje;
taṇhā bhavaparikkhī-
ṇaṃ,
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāh-
maṇaṃ.

hitvā mānusakaṃ yo-
gaṃ,
dibbaṃ yogaṃ upac-
cagā;
sabbayogavisamū-
taṃ,
tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāh-
maṇaṃ.

Having abandoned delight and discontent,
 he has become cool, without belongings;
 the hero who has conquered all the worlds,
 it is him I call a brahmin.

He who knows death of beings,
 and all their arisings;
 unattached, well-fared, awakened,
 it is him I call a brahmin.

For he who devas, ghandhabbas and human beings,
 cannot understand his destiny;
 The asava-free, the arahant,
 it is him I call a brahmin.

For he who after and before,
 and in-between there is

hitvā ratiñca aratiṃ,
 sītībhūtaṃ nirūpa-
 dhiṃ;
 sabbālokābhibhūṃ
 vīraṃ,
 tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

cutiṃ yo vedi sattā-
 naṃ,
 upapattiñca sabbaso;
 asattaṃ sugataṃ buddhaṃ,
 tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

yassa gatiṃ na jānanti,
 devā gandhabbamānusa;
 khīṇāsavaṃ arahantaṃ,
 tamaḥaṃ brūmi brāhmaṇaṃ.

yassa pure ca pacchāca,
 majjhe ca natthi kiñ-

not something;
owning nothing, a dis-
owner,
it is him I call a brahmin.

The chief bull, the most
excellent hero,
the great seer, victorious;
the Buddha unperturbed,
fully cleansed [with the
inner] bathing,
it is him I call a brahmin.

He who knows his former
abodes,
and sees the heavens and
the lower worlds;
then attained to the oblit-
eration of birth,
it is him I call a brahmin.

Truly this is a designa-
tion in the world,
the assignment of name
and clan;
arisen according to com-
mon usage,
it is assigned as so and

canam;
akiñcanam anādā-
nam,
tamahaṃ brūmi brāh-
maṇam.

usabham pavaram vī-
ram,
mahesiṃ vijitāvinam;
anejam nahātakaṃ
buddham,
tamahaṃ brūmi brāh-
maṇam.

pubbenivāsaṃ yo vedi,
saggāpāyañca pas-
sati;
atho jātikkhayaṃ patto,
tamahaṃ brūmi brāh-
maṇam.

samaññā'hesā lokas-
miṃ,
nāmagottaṃ pakappi-
taṃ;
samucca¹³ samudāga-
taṃ,

¹³sammuccā - sīmu. ■

so.

For a long time it has
persisted,
entrenched in views, not
understanding;
from not understanding
they declare to us,
one is a brahmin by
birth.

Neither by birth is one a
brahmin,
nor by birth is one not a
brahmin;
by kamma is one a brah-
min,
by kamma is one not a
brahmin.

By kamma is one a farmer,

by kamma is one a crafts-
man;
by kamma is one a mer-
chant,
by kamma is one a ser-
vant.

tattha tattha pakappi-
taṃ.

dīgharattamanusayi-
taṃ,
diṭṭhigatamajānataṃ;
ajānantā¹⁴ no pabru-
vanti¹⁵,
jātiyā hoti brāhmaṇo.

na jaccā brāhmaṇo¹⁶
hoti,
na jaccā hoti abrāh-
maṇo¹⁷;
kammanā brāhmaṇo¹⁸
hoti,
kammanā hoti abrāh-
maṇo

kassako kammanā
hoti,
sippiko hoti kammanā;

¹⁴jānantā - sīmu.■

¹⁵pabrunti - machasaṃ■

¹⁶vasalo - syā■

¹⁷pabrunti - machasaṃ■

¹⁸vasalo - syā■

A thief too, one comes to
 be by kamma,
 by kamma is one also a
 soldier;
 by kamma is one a sacri-
 ficing priest,
 a king too, one comes to
 be by kamma.

The wise ones see kamma,
 in just this way as it has
 come to be;
 the seers of precedent
 co-arising,
 experts in the results of
 kamma.

By kamma the world
 keeps rolling,
 by kamma the genera-
 tions goes on;
 beings are bound by
 kamma,
 like the linchpin of a
 travelling chariot.

vāṇijo kammanā hoti,
 pessiko hoti kammanā.

coropi kammanā hoti,
 yodhājīvopi kammanā;

yājako kammanā hoti,
 rājāpi hoti kammanā.

evametaṃ yathābhū-
 taṃ,
 kammaṃ passanti
 paṇḍitā;
 paṭiccasamuppāda-
 dasā,
 kammavipākakovidā.

kammanā vattati loko,

kammanā vattati pajā;

kammanibandhanā
 sattā,
 rathassāṇīva yāyato.

By ardency in the life of
purity,
by self-control and tam-
ing;
by this one is a brahmin,
this is the brahmin unsur-
passed.

Endowed with the triple
knowledges,
the peaceful one with
renewed being obliterated;
know him thus, O Vaset-
tha,
as Brahma, the capable
one who understands
distinctively.

5. When thus was said, the
young brahmins Vasettha
Bharadvaja said this to the
Auspicious One: “Excellent, O
Bhante! Excellent, O Bhante!
Just as, O Bhante, one might
set upright what has been
overturned, or open up what
has been closed, or show a
path to one who is lost, or

tapena brahmacari-
yena,
saṃyamena damena
ca;
etena brāhmaṇo hoti,
etaṃ brāhmaṇamutta-
maṃ.

tīhi vijjāhi sampanno,
santo khīṇapunab-
bhavo;
evaṃ vāseṭṭha jānāhi,
brahmā sakko vijāna-
tanti.

evaṃ vutte vāseṭṭha-
bhāradvājā māṇavā
bhagavantam etada-
vocaṃ: abhikkantaṃ
bho gotama, abhik-
kantaṃ bho gotama,
seyyathāpi bho go-
tama, nikkujjitaṃ
vā ukkujjeyya, pa-
ṭicchannaṃ vā viva-
reyya, mūḷhassa vā

bear an oil lamp in the darkness so that those with good eyesight can see forms, just so has the Dhamma been explained by the venerable Gotama in countless ways. We go, O Bhante, to the Auspicious Gotama, as refuge, and to the Dhamma, and to the Sangha of bhikkhus. May Master Gotama bear it in mind, that we are lay disciples who have gone for refuge from today for as long as life lasts.”

maggam ācikkheyya,
andhakāre vā tela-
pajjotaṃ dhāreyya,
cakkhumanto rūpāni
dakkhintī'ti. evame-
vaṃ bhotā gotamena
anekapariyāyena
dhammo pakāsito,
ete mayaṃ bhavan-
taṃ gotamaṃ sa-
raṇaṃ gacchāma,
dhammañca bhik-
khusaṅghañca. upā-
sake no bhavaṃ go-
tamo dhāretu ajja-
tagge pāṇupetaṃ
saraṇaṃ gateti.

